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CONCLUSION

"The eternal people do not fear a long road."

Yehoshua Weitzman

Around midnight on 23 June 2016, my phone buzzed with a late-night news alert—Nigel Farage was conceding defeat. "It looks like Remain will edge it," said Farage, the leader of the UK Independence Party and an outspoken voice for "Brexit", the euphemism for pulling the United Kingdom out of the European Union. The question had gone to a public referendum, and here was Farage, moments after the polls closed, admitting that early indications weren't good for his camp.

But to borrow an Israeli expression, we went to bed with Remain, and woke up with Leave. The latter pulled out an unexpected victory with almost 52 per cent of the vote, a result that sent shockwaves around the world. Sterling plunged to a thirty-one-year low against the dollar; trillions of dollars were erased from global stock markets in a matter of days; Prime Minister David Cameron announced his resignation, and Britain lapsed into a period of protracted political chaos. "Perhaps you can help by writing a piece about what it's like to live in a small, arrogant, isolated, xenophobic nation when all your neighbors hate you," one of my British editors emailed, only half in jest.

Summer is the silly season for journalists, when the serious news-makers go on holiday and the paper fills up with frivolous stories like Hamas capturing an alleged spy dolphin off the coast of Gaza. (The more colorful term in Hebrew, borrowed from eastern Europe, is *onat hamelafefonim*, the "season of the cucumbers".) Not so in 2016. The world seemed to be shaking. There was a wave of attacks attributed to the Islamic State: the suicide bombing at Istanbul's main airport; the hit-and-run atrocity that killed eighty-six people on the corniche in Nice; the shooting rampage at a